

Bolt - What You Can Build

Short reference for app types that work well in this project, plus current limits.

Works best

- React + Vite + TypeScript frontends with Tailwind CSS
- Simple CRUD apps - to-do lists, notes, forms, dashboards (localStorage or in-memory is fine)
- SaaS-style apps - login/signup, protected routes, user-specific data
- Data-backed tools - booking, CRM-lite, inventory, internal admin panels
- Supabase apps - Postgres tables, Row Level Security, email/password auth
- Iterative edits - ask Bolt to change UI, add pages, or fix bugs in an existing project

Good prompts: "Build a to-do list with localStorage", "team task board with login", "shop booking dashboard".

Possible, with caveats

- Landing / marketing pages (no auth) - turn off full-stack orchestration or expect extra guidance
- Other starters - Astro, Next.js, etc. via template selection (not the default path)
- Discuss mode - planning and explanations without generating a full app
- No Supabase connected - Bolt can still build a frontend-only app; auth/database features are skipped or mocked

What you need

Goal | Requirement

Code generation | LLM API key (e.g. OpenAI)

Auto database + auth | Supabase access token + project

Live preview | Runs in browser via WebContainer (npm run dev)

Limitations

- Browser sandbox only - no native mobile/desktop apps, no arbitrary long-running servers or cron jobs
- Supabase is external - database/auth run in Supabase cloud, not inside the preview iframe
- Auth - email/password via Supabase only; no magic links, social login, or custom auth servers out of the box
- Model output format - apps load fastest when the model emits `<boltArtifact>` / `<boltAction>` tags; plain markdown code blocks are auto-detected but less reliable
- Heavy workloads - video, live collaboration, blockchain, and enterprise compliance are not first-class
- Preview depends on generated code - missing env vars, broken imports, or auth-only shells can show a blank preview until fixed

Quick test prompts

Smoke test (no backend):**

Build a simple to-do list. Add, complete, delete tasks. Persist with localStorage.

Full-stack (needs Supabase):**

Build a pet grooming scheduler with login, pets, services, and appointments.

Landing only:**

Build a one-page product landing site with hero, features, and contact form. No login.